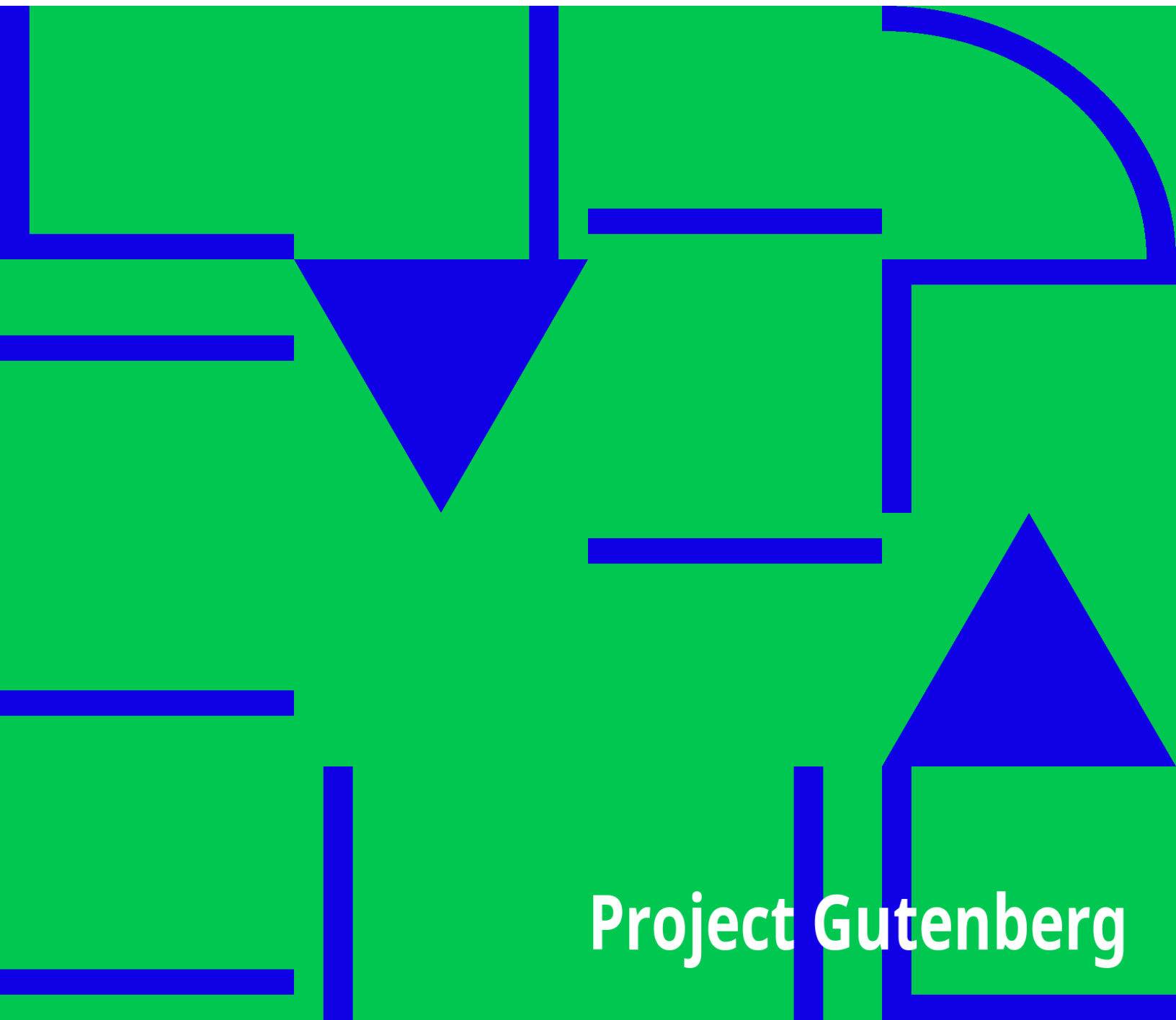


# Lyrics of Earth

Archibald Lampman

An abstract geometric pattern composed of various blue shapes on a green background. The shapes include horizontal and vertical lines of varying lengths, a large downward-pointing triangle in the center-left, a curved line in the top right corner, and an upward-pointing triangle in the bottom right. The pattern is asymmetrical and modern in style.

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# Lyrics of Earth

Archibald Lampman

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# **LYRICS OF EARTH**

**BY**

# ARCHIBALD LAMPMAN



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---

## TO MY MOTHER

Mother, to whose valiant will,  
    Battling long ago,  
What the heaping years fulfil,  
    Light and song, I owe;  
Send my little book a-field,  
    Fronting praise or blame  
With the shining flag and shield  
    Of your name.

---

## THE SWEETNESS OF LIFE

It fell on a day I was happy,  
    And the winds, the concave sky,  
The flowers and the beasts in the  
    meadow  
    Seemed happy even as I;  
And I stretched my hands to the  
    meadow,  
    To the bird, the beast, the tree:  
"Why are ye all so happy?"  
    I cried, and they answered me.

What sayest thou, Oh meadow,  
    That stretches so wide, so far,  
That none can say how many  
    Thy misty marguerites are?  
And what say ye, red roses,  
    That o'er the sun-blanced wall  
From your high black-shadowed  
    trellis  
    Like flame or blood-drops fall?  
    "We are born, we are  
        reared, and we  
        linger  
        A various space and  
        die;  
    We dream, and are bright  
        and happy,  
    But we cannot answer  
        why."

What sayest thou, Oh shadow,  
    That from the dreaming hill  
All down the broadening valley

Liest so sharp and still?  
And thou, Oh murmuring brooklet,  
Whereby in the noonday gleam  
The loosestrife burns like ruby,  
And the branchèd asters dream?

"We are born, we are  
reared, and we  
linger  
A various space and  
die;  
We dream and are very  
happy,  
But we cannot answer  
why."

And then of myself I questioned,  
That like a ghost the while  
Stood from me and calmly answered,  
With slow and curious smile:  
"Thou art born as the flowers, and  
wilt linger  
Thine own short space and die;  
Thou dream'st and art strangely  
happy,  
But thou canst not answer why."

---

## GOD-SPEED TO THE SNOW

March is slain; the keen winds fly;  
Nothing more is thine to do;  
April kisses thee good-bye;  
Thou must haste and follow too;  
Silent friend that guarded well  
Withered things to make us glad,  
Shyest friend that could not tell  
Half the kindly thought he had.  
Haste thee, speed thee, O kind snow;  
Down the dripping valleys go,  
From the fields and gleaming  
          meadows,  
Where the slaying hours behold thee,  
From the forests whose slim  
          shadows,  
Brown and leafless cannot fold thee,  
Through the cedar lands aflame  
With gold light that cleaves and  
          quivers,  
Songs that winter may not tame,  
Drone of pines and laugh of rivers.  
May thy passing joyous be  
To thy father, the great sea,  
For the sun is getting stronger;  
Earth hath need of thee no longer;  
Go, kind snow, God-speed to thee!

---

## APRIL IN THE HILLS

To-day the world is wide and fair  
With sunny fields of lucid air,  
And waters dancing everywhere;  
    The snow is almost gone;  
The noon is builded high with light,  
And over heaven's liquid height,  
In steady fleets serene and white,  
    The happy clouds go on.

The channels run, the bare earth  
    steams,  
And every hollow rings and gleams  
With jetting falls and dashing  
    streams;  
    The rivers burst and fill;  
The fields are full of little lakes,  
And when the romping wind awakes  
The water ruffles blue and shakes,  
    And the pines roar on the hill.

The crows go by, a noisy throng;  
About the meadows all day long  
The shore-lark drops his brittle song;  
    And up the leafless tree  
The nut-hatch runs, and nods, and  
    clings;  
The bluebird dips with flashing  
    wings,  
The robin flutes, the sparrow sings,  
    And the swallows float and flee.

I break the spirit's cloudy bands,  
A wanderer in enchanted lands,

I feel the sun upon my hands;  
    And far from care and strife  
The broad earth bids me forth. I rise  
With lifted brow and upward eyes.  
I bathe my spirit in blue skies,  
    And taste the springs of life.

I feel the tumult of new birth;  
I waken with the wakening earth;  
I match the bluebird in her mirth;  
    And wild with wind and sun,  
A treasurer of immortal days,  
I roam the glorious world with praise,  
The hillsides and the woodland ways,  
    Till earth and I are one.

---

## FOREST MOODS

There is singing of birds in the deep  
    wet woods,  
In the heart of the listening solitudes,  
Pewees, and thrushes, and sparrows,  
    not few,  
And all the notes of their throats are  
    true.

The thrush from the innermost ash  
    takes on  
A tender dream of the treasured and  
    gone;  
But the sparrow singeth with pride  
    and cheer  
Of the might and light of the present  
    and here.

There is shining of flowers in the  
    deep wet woods,  
In the heart of the sensitive solitudes,  
The roseate bell and the lily are there,  
And every leaf of their sheaf is fair.

Careless and bold, without dream of  
    woe,  
The trilliums scatter their flags snow;  
But the pale wood-daffodil covers her  
    face,  
Agloom with the doom of a sorrowful  
    race.

---

## THE RETURN OF THE YEAR

Again the warm bare earth, the noon  
That hangs upon her healing  
scars,  
The midnight round, the great red  
moon,  
The mother with her brood of  
stars,

The mist-rack and the wakening rain  
Blown soft in many a forest way,  
The yellowing elm-trees, and again  
The blood-root in its sheath of  
gray.

The vesper-sparrow's song, the stress  
Of yearning notes that gush and  
stream,  
The lyric joy, the tenderness,  
And once again the dream! the  
dream!

A touch of far-off joy and power,  
A something it is life to learn,  
Comes back to earth, and one short  
hour  
The glammers of the gods return.

This life's old mood and cult of care  
Falls smitten by an older truth,  
And the gray world wins back to her  
The rapture of her vanished  
youth.

Dead thoughts revive, and he that  
    heeds  
    Shall hear, as by a spirit led,  
A song among the golden reeds:  
    "The gods are vanished but not  
    dead!"

For one short hour; unseen yet near,  
    They haunt us, a forgotten  
    mood,  
A glory upon mead and mere,  
    A magic in the leafless wood.

At morning we shall catch the glow  
    Of Dian's quiver on the hill,  
And somewhere in the glades I know  
    That Pan is at his piping still.

---

## FAVORITES OF PAN

Once, long ago, before the gods  
    Had left this earth, by stream  
        and forest glade,  
Where the first plough upturned the  
    clinging sods,  
Or the lost shepherd strayed,

Often to the tired listener's ear  
    There came at noonday or  
        beneath the stars  
A sound, he knew not whence, so  
    sweet and clear,  
That all his aches and scars

And every brooded bitterness,  
    Fallen asunder from his soul  
        took flight,  
Like mist or darkness yielding to the  
    press  
Of an unnamed delight,—

A sudden brightness of the heart,  
    A magic fire drawn down from  
        Paradise,  
That rent the cloud with golden  
    gleam apart,—  
And far before his eyes

The loveliness and calm of earth  
    Lay like a limitless dream  
        remote and strange,  
The joy, the strife, the triumph and  
    the mirth,

And the enchanted change;

And so he followed the sweet sound,  
Till faith had traversed her  
appointed span,  
And murmured as he pressed the  
sacred ground:  
"It is the note of Pan!"

Now though no more by marsh or  
stream  
Or dewy forest sounds the secret  
reed—  
For Pan is gone—Ah yet, the infinite  
dream  
Still lives for them that heed.

In April, when the turning year  
Regains its pensive youth, and a  
soft breath  
And amorous influence over marsh  
and mere  
Dissolves the grasp of death,

To them that are in love with life,  
Wandering like children with  
untroubled eyes,  
Far from the noise of cities and the  
strife,  
Strange flute-like voices rise

At noon and in the quiet of the night  
From every watery waste; and in  
that hour  
The same strange spell, the same  
unnamed delight,  
Enfolds them in its power.

An old-world joyousness supreme,  
The warmth and glow of an  
immortal balm,  
The mood-touch of the gods, the  
endless dream,  
The high lethean calm.

They see, wide on the eternal way,  
The services of earth, the life of  
man;  
And, listening to the magic cry they  
say:  
"It is the note of Pan!"

For, long ago, when the new strains  
Of hostile hymns and  
conquering faiths grew  
keen,  
And the old gods from their deserted  
fanes,  
Fled silent and unseen,

So, too, the goat-foot Pan, not less  
Sadly obedient to the mightier  
hand,  
Cut him new reeds, and in a sore  
distress  
Passed out from land to land;

And lingering by each haunt he knew,  
Of fount or sinuous stream or  
grassy marge,  
He set the syrinx to his lips, and blew  
A note divinely large;

And all around him on the wet  
Cool earth the frogs came up,  
and with a smile

He took them in his hairy hands, and  
set

His mouth to theirs awhile,

And blew into their velvet throats;

And ever from that hour the  
frogs repeat

The murmur of Pan's pipes, the notes,

And answers strange and sweet;

And they that hear them are renewed

By knowledge in some god-like  
touch conveyed,

Entering again into the eternal mood,

Wherein the world was made.

---

## THE MEADOW

Here when the cloudless April days  
begin,  
And the quaint crows flock  
thicker day by day,  
Filling the forests with a pleasant din,  
And the soiled snow creeps  
secretly away,  
Comes the small busy sparrow,  
primed with glee,  
First preacher in the naked  
wilderness,  
Piping an end to all the  
long distress  
From every fence and every leafless  
tree.

Now with soft slight and viewless  
artifice  
Winter's iron work is  
wondrously undone;  
In all the little hollows cored with ice  
The clear brown pools  
stand simmering in  
the sun,  
Frail lucid worlds, upon whose  
tremulous floors  
All day the wandering  
water-bugs at will,  
Shy mariners whose oars  
are never still,  
Voyage and dream about the  
heightening shores.

The bluebird, peeping from the  
    gnarlèd thorn,  
    Prattles upon his frolic  
        flute, or flings,  
In bounding flight across the golden  
    morn,  
    An azure gleam from off  
        his splendid wings.  
Here the slim-pinioned swallows  
    sweep and pass  
    Down to the far-off river;  
        the black crow  
    With wise and wary visage  
        to and fro  
Settles and stalks about the withered  
    grass.

Here, when the murmurous May-day  
    is half gone,  
    The watchful lark before  
        my feet takes flight,  
And wheeling to some lonelier field  
    far on,  
    Drops with obstreperous  
        cry; and here at  
        night,  
When the first star precedes the great  
    red moon,  
    The shore-lark tinkles from  
        the darkening field,  
    Somewhere, we know not,  
        in the dusk  
        concealed,  
His little creakling and continuous  
    tune.

Here, too, the robins, lusty as of old,

Hunt the waste grass for  
forage, or prolong  
From every quarter of these fields the  
bold,  
Blithe phrases of their  
never-finished song.  
The white-throat's distant descant  
with slow stress  
Note after note upon the  
noonday falls,  
Filling the leisured air at  
intervals  
With his own mood of piercing  
pensiveness.

How often from this windy upland  
perch,  
Mine eyes have seen the  
forest break in  
bloom,  
The rose-red maple and the golden  
birch,  
The dusty yellow of the  
elms, the gloom  
Of the tall poplar hung with tasseled  
black;  
Ah, I have watched, till eye  
and ear and brain  
Grew full of dreams as  
they, the moted  
plain,  
The sun-steeped wood, the marsh-  
land at its back,  
The valley where the river wheels  
and fills,

Yon city glimmering in its  
smoky shroud,  
And out at the last misty rim the hills  
Blue and far off and  
mounded like a  
cloud,  
And here the noisy rutted road that  
goes  
Down the slope yonder,  
flanked on either  
side  
With the smooth-furrowed  
fields flung black  
and wide,  
Patched with pale water sleeping in  
the rows.

So as I watched the crowded leaves  
expand,  
The bloom break sheath,  
the summer's  
strength uprear,  
In earth's great mother's heart already  
planned  
The heaped and burgeoned  
plenty of the year,  
Even as she from out her wintry cell  
My spirit also sprang to life  
anew,  
And day by day as the  
spring's bounty  
grew,  
Its conquering joy possessed me like  
a spell.

In reverie by day and midnight dream

I sought these upland fields  
and walked apart,  
Musing on Nature, till my thought did  
seem

To read the very secrets of  
her heart;  
In mooded moments earnest and  
sublime

I stored the themes of many  
a future song,  
Whose substance should be  
Nature's, clear and  
strong,  
Bound in a casket of majestic rhyme.

Brave bud-like plans that never  
reached the fruit,  
Like hers our mother's who  
with every hour,  
Easily replenished from the sleepless  
root,

Covers her bosom with  
fresh bud and  
flower;  
Yet I was happy as young lovers be,  
Who in the season of their  
passion's birth  
Deem that they have their  
utmost worship's  
worth,  
If love be near them, just to hear and  
see.

---

## IN MAY

Grief was my master yesternight;  
    To-morrow I may grieve  
        again;  
But now along the windy  
    plain  
    The clouds have taken  
        flight.

The sowers in the furrows go;  
    The lusty river brimmeth  
        on;  
The curtains from the hills  
    are gone;  
    The leaves are out;  
        and lo,

The silvery distance of the day,  
    The light horizons, and  
        between  
The glory of the perfect  
    green,  
    The tumult of the May.

The bobolinks at noonday sing  
    More softly than the softest  
        flute,  
And lightlier than the  
    lightest lute  
    Their fairy tambours  
        ring.

The roads far off are towered with  
    dust;

The cherry-blooms are  
swept and thinned;  
In yonder swaying elms the  
wind  
Is charging gust on  
gust.

But here there is no stir at all;  
The ministers of sun and  
shadow  
Horde all the perfumes of  
the meadow  
Behind a grassy wall.

An infant rivulet wind-free  
Adown the guarded hollow  
sets,  
Over whose brink the  
violets  
Are nodding  
peacefully.

From pool to pool it prattles by;  
The flashing swallows dip  
and pass,  
Above the tufted marish  
grass,  
And here at rest am I.

I care not for the old distress,  
Nor if to-morrow bid me  
moan;  
To-day is mine, and I have  
known  
An hour of  
blessedness.

---

## LIFE AND NATURE

I passed through the gates of the city,  
The streets were strange and  
still,  
Through the doors of the open  
churches  
The organs were moaning shrill.

Through the doors and the great high  
windows  
I heard the murmur of prayer,  
And the sound of their solemn  
singing  
Streamed out on the sunlit air;

A sound of some great burden  
That lay on the world's dark  
breast,  
Of the old, and the sick, and the  
lonely,  
And the weary that cried for rest.

I strayed through the midst of the city  
Like one distracted or mad.  
"Oh, Life! Oh, Life!" I kept saying,  
And the very word seemed sad.

I passed through the gates of the city,  
And I heard the small birds sing,  
I laid me down in the meadows  
Afar from the bell-ringing.

In the depth and the bloom of the  
meadows

I lay on the earth's quiet breast,  
The poplar fanned me with shadows,  
And the veery sang me to rest.

Blue, blue was the heaven above me,  
And the earth green at my feet;  
"Oh, Life! Oh, Life!" I kept saying,  
And the very word seemed  
sweet.

---

## WITH THE NIGHT

O doubts, dull passions, and base  
    fears,  
    That harassed and oppressed the  
        day,  
Ye poor remorsees and vain tears,  
    That shook this house of clay:

All heaven to the western bars  
    Is glittering with the darker  
        dawn;  
Here with the earth, the night, the  
    stars,  
    Ye have no place: begone!

---

## JUNE

Long, long ago, it seems, this summer  
morn

That pale-browed April  
passed with pensive  
tread

Through the frore woods,  
and from its frost-  
bound bed

Woke the arbutus with her silver  
horn;

And now May,  
too, is  
fled,

The flower-crowned month, the  
merry laughing May,  
With rosy feet and fingers  
dewy wet,

Leaving the woods and all cool  
gardens gay  
With tulips and the scented  
violet.

Gone are the wind-flower and the  
adder-tongue

And the sad drooping  
bellwort, and no  
more

The snowy trilliums crowd  
the forest's floor;

The purpling grasses are no longer  
young,

And summer's  
wide-set  
door  
O'er the thronged hills and the broad  
panting earth  
Lest in the torrent of the  
later bloom,  
Haytime, and harvest, and the after  
mirth,  
The slow soft rain, the  
rushing thunder  
plume.

All day in garden alleys moist and  
dim,  
The humid air is burdened  
with the rose;  
In moss-deep woods the  
creamy orchid  
blows;  
And now the vesper-sparrows'  
pealing hymn  
From every  
orchard  
close  
At eve comes flooding rich and  
silvery;  
The daisies in great  
meadows swing and  
shine;  
And with the wind a sound as of the  
sea  
Roars in the maples and the  
topmost pine.

High in the hills the solitary thrush

Tunes magically his music  
of fine dreams,  
In briary dells, by boulder-  
broken streams;  
And wide and far on nebulous fields  
aflush

The mellow  
morning  
gleams.  
The orange cone-flowers purple-  
bossed are there,  
The meadow's bold-eyed  
gypsies deep of hue,  
And slender hawkweed tall and softly  
fair,  
And rosy tops of fleabane  
veiled with dew.

So with thronged voices and  
unhasting flight  
The fervid hours with long  
return go by;  
The far-heard hylas piping  
shrill and high  
Tell the slow moments of the solemn  
night

With unremitting  
cry;  
Lustrous and large out of the  
gathering drouth  
The planets gleam; the  
baleful Scorpion  
Trails his dim fires along the droused  
south;  
The silent world-incrusted  
round moves on.

And all the dim night long the moon's  
white beams

Nestle deep down in every  
brooding tree,

And sleeping birds, touched  
with a silly glee,

Waken at midnight from their blissful  
dreams,

And carol  
brokenly.

Dim surging motions and uneasy  
dreads

Scare the light slumber  
from men's busy  
eyes,

And parted lovers on their restless  
beds

Toss and yearn out, and  
cannot sleep for  
sighs.

Oft have I striven, sweet month, to  
figure thee,

As dreamers of old time  
were wont to feign,  
In living form of flesh, and  
striven in vain;

Yet when some sudden old-world  
mystery

Of passion fired  
my brain,

Thy shape hath flashed upon me like  
no dream,

Wandering with scented  
curls that heaped the  
breeze,

Or by the hollow of some reeded  
stream  
Sitting waist-deep in white  
anemones;

And even as I glimpsed thee thou  
wert gone,  
A dream for mortal eyes too  
proudly coy,  
Yet in thy place for subtle  
thought's employ  
The golden magic clung, a light that  
shone

And filled me  
with thy  
joy.

Before me like a mist that streamed  
and fell

All names and shapes of  
antique beauty  
passed

In garlanded procession with the  
swell

Of flutes between the  
beechen stems; and  
last,

I saw the Arcadian valley, the loved  
wood,

Alpheus stream divine, the  
sighing shore,

And through the cool green  
glades, awake once  
more,

Psyche, the white-limbed goddess,  
still pursued,

Fleet-footed as of  
yore,  
The noonday ringing with her  
frighted peals,  
Down the bright sward and  
through the reeds  
she ran,  
Urged by the mountain echoes, at her  
heels  
The hot-blown cheeks and  
trampling feet of  
Pan.

---

# DISTANCE

To the distance! Ah, the distance!  
Blue and broad and dim!  
Peace is not in burgh or meadow,  
But beyond the rim.

Aye, beyond it, far beyond it;  
Follow still my soul,  
Till this earth is lost in heaven,  
And thou feel'st the whole.

---

## THE BIRD AND THE HOUR

The sun looks over a little hill  
And floods the valley with gold

—

A torrent of gold;  
And the hither field is green and still;  
Beyond it a cloud outrolled,  
Is glowing molten and bright;  
And soon the hill, and the valley and  
all,

With a quiet fall,  
Shall be gathered into the night.  
And yet a moment more,

Out of the silent  
wood,

As if from the closing door  
Of another world and another lovelier  
mood,

Hear'st thou the hermit pour—

So sweet! so  
magical!

—

His golden music, ghostly beautiful.

---

## AFTER RAIN

For three whole days across the sky,  
In sullen packs that loomed and  
    broke,  
With flying fringes dim as smoke,  
The columns of the rain went by;  
At every hour the wind awoke;  
    The darkness passed upon  
        the plain;  
    The great drops rattled at  
        the pane.

Now piped the wind, or far aloof  
Fell to a sough remote and dull;  
And all night long with rush and lull  
The rain kept drumming on the roof:  
I heard till ear and sense were full  
    The clash or silence of the  
        leaves,  
    The gurgle in the creaking  
        eaves.

But when the fourth day came—at  
    noon,  
The darkness and the rain were by;  
The sunward roofs were steaming  
    dry;  
And all the world was flecked and  
    strewn  
With shadows from a fleecy sky.  
    The haymakers were forth  
        and gone,  
    And every rillet laughed  
        and shone.

Then, too, on me that loved so well  
The world, despairing in her blight,  
Uplifted with her least delight,  
On me, as on the earth, there fell  
New happiness of mirth and might;  
    I strode the valleys pied and  
        still;  
    I climbed upon the breezy  
        hill.

I watched the gray hawk wheel and  
    drop,  
Sole shadow on the shining world;  
I saw the mountains clothed and  
    curled,  
With forest ruffling to the top;  
I saw the river's length unfurled,  
    Pale silver down the fruited  
        plain,  
    Grown great and stately  
        with the rain.

Through miles of shadow and soft  
    heat,  
Where field and fallow, fence and  
    tree,  
Were all one world of greenery,  
I heard the robin ringing sweet,  
The sparrow piping silverly,  
    The thrushes at the forest's  
        hem;  
And as I went I sang with  
    them.

---

## CLOUD-BREAK

With a turn of his magical rod,  
That extended and suddenly shone,  
From the round of his glory some god  
Looks forth and is gone.

To the summit of heaven the clouds  
Are rolling aloft like steam;  
There's a break in their infinite  
          shrouds,  
And below it a gleam.  
O'er the drift of the river a whiff  
Comes out from the blossoming  
          shore;  
And the meadows are greening, as if  
They never were green before.

The islands are kindled with gold  
And russet and emerald dye;  
And the interval waters outrolled  
Are more blue than the sky.  
From my feet to the heart of the hills  
The spirits of May intervene,  
And a vapor of azure distills  
Like a breath on the opaline green.

Only a moment!—and then  
The chill and the shadow decline,  
On the eyes of rejuvenate men  
That were wide and divine.

---

## THE MOON-PATH

The full, clear moon uprose and  
    spread  
    Her cold, pale splendor o'er the  
        sea;  
A light-strewn path that seemed to  
    lead  
    Outward into eternity.  
Between the darkness and the gleam  
    An old-world spell encompassed  
        me:  
Methought that in a godlike dream  
    I trod upon the sea.

And lo! upon that glimmering road,  
    In shining companies unfurled,  
The trains of many a primal god,  
    The monsters of the elder world;  
Strange creatures that, with silver  
    wings,  
    Scarce touched the ocean's  
        thronging floor,  
The phantoms of old tales, and things  
    Whose shapes are known no  
        more.

Giants and demi-gods who once  
    Were dwellers of the earth and  
        sea,  
And they who from Deucalion's  
    stones,  
    Rose men without an infancy;  
Beings on whose majestic lids

Time's solemn secrets seemed to  
    dwell,  
Tritons and pale-limbed Nereids,  
    And forms of heaven and hell.

Some who were heroes long of yore,  
    When the great world was hale  
        and young;  
And some whose marble lips yet pour  
    The murmur of an antique  
        tongue;  
Sad queens, whose names are like  
    soft moans,  
    Whose griefs were written up in  
        gold;  
And some who on their silver thrones  
    Were goddesses of old.

As if I had been dead indeed,  
    And come into some after-land,  
I saw them pass me, and take heed,  
    And touch me with each mighty  
        hand;  
And evermore a murmurous stream,  
    So beautiful they seemed to me,  
Not less than in a godlike dream  
    I trod the shining sea.

---

## COMFORT OF THE FIELDS

What would'st thou have for  
    easement after grief,  
When the rude world hath used  
    thee with despite,  
And care sits at thine elbow day  
    and night,  
Filching thy pleasures like a subtle  
    thief?  
To me, when life besets me in such  
    wise,  
'Tis sweetest to break forth, to drop  
    the chain,  
And grasp the freedom of this  
    pleasant earth,  
To roam in idleness and sober  
    mirth,  
Through summer airs and summer  
    lands, and drain  
The comfort of wide fields unto tired  
    eyes.

By hills and waters, farms and  
    solitudes,  
To wander by the day with  
    wilful feet;  
Through fielded valleys wide  
    with yellowing wheat;  
Along gray roads that run between  
    deep woods,  
Murmurous and cool; through  
    hallowed slopes of pine,

Where the long daylight dreams,  
unpierced, unstirred,  
And only the rich-throated  
thrush is heard;  
By lonely forest brooks that froth and  
shine  
In bouldered crannies buried in  
the hills;  
By broken beeches tangled with wild  
vine,  
And log-strewn rivers  
murmurous with mills.

In upland pastures, sown with gold,  
and sweet  
With the keen perfume of the  
ripening grass,  
Where wings of birds and filmy  
shadows pass,  
Spread thick as stars with shining  
marguerite;  
To haunt old fences overgrown with  
brier,  
Muffled in vines, and hawthorns,  
and wild cherries,  
Rank poisonous ivies, red-  
bunched elderberries,  
And pièd blossoms to the heart's  
desire,  
Gray mullein towering into  
yellow bloom,  
Pink-tasseled milkweed,  
breathing dense perfume,  
And swarthy vervain, tipped with  
violet fire.

To hear at eve the bleating of far  
flocks,  
The mud-hen's whistle from the  
marsh at morn;  
To skirt with deafened ears and  
brain o'erborne  
Some foam-filled rapid charging  
down its rocks  
With iron roar of waters; far away  
Across wide-reeded meres,  
pensive with noon,  
To hear the querulous outcry of  
the loon;  
To lie among deep rocks, and watch  
all day  
On liquid heights the snowy  
clouds melt by;  
Or hear from wood-capped mountain-  
brows the jay  
Pierce the bright morning with  
his jibing cry.

To feast on summer sounds; the jolted  
wains,  
The thrasher humming from the  
farm near by,  
The prattling cricket's  
intermittent cry,  
The locust's rattle from the sultry  
lanes;  
Or in the shadow of some oaken  
spray,  
To watch, as through a mist of  
light and dreams,  
The far-off hay-fields, where the  
dusty teams

Drive round and round the lessening  
squares of hay,  
And hear upon the wind, now  
loud, now low,  
With drowsy cadence half a summer's  
day,  
The clatter of the reapers come  
and go.

Far violet hills, horizons filmed with  
showers,  
The murmur of cool streams, the  
forest's gloom,  
The voices of the breathing  
grass, the hum  
Of ancient gardens overbanked with  
flowers:  
Thus, with a smile as golden as the  
dawn,  
And cool fair fingers radiantly  
divine,  
The mighty mother brings us in  
her hand,  
For all tired eyes and foreheads  
pinched and wan,  
Her restful cup, her beaker of bright  
wine:  
Drink, and be filled, and ye shall  
understand!

---

## AT THE FERRY

On such a day the shrunken stream  
Spends its last water and runs  
dry;

Clouds like far turrets in a dream  
Stand baseless in the burning  
sky.

On such a day at every rod  
The toilers in the hay-field halt,  
With dripping brows, and the parched  
sod  
Yields to the crushing foot like  
salt.

But here a little wind astir,  
Seen waterward in jetting lines,  
From yonder hillside topped with fir  
Comes pungent with the breath  
of pines;  
And here when all the noon hangs  
still,  
White-hot upon the city tiles,  
A perfume and a wintry chill  
Breathe from the yellow lumber-  
piles.

And all day long there falls a blur  
Of noises upon listless ears,  
The rumble of the trams, the stir  
Of barges at the clacking piers;  
The champ of wheels, the crash of  
steam,  
And ever, without change or  
stay,

The drone, as through a troubled  
dream,  
Of waters falling far away.

A tug-boat up the farther shore  
Half pants, half whistles, in her  
draught;  
The cadence of a creaking oar  
Falls drowsily; a corded raft  
Creeps slowly in the noonday gleam,  
And wheresoe'er a shadow  
sleeps  
The men lie by, or half a-dream,  
Stand leaning at the idle sweeps.

And all day long in the quiet bay  
The eddying amber depths  
retard,  
And hold, as in a ring, at play,  
The heavy saw-logs notched and  
scarred;  
And yonder between cape and shoal,  
Where the long currents swing  
and shift,  
An aged punt-man with his pole  
Is searching in the parted drift.

At moments from the distant glare  
The murmur of a railway steals  
Round yonder jutting point the air  
Is beaten with the puff of  
wheels;  
And here at hand an open mill,  
Strong clamor at perpetual drive,  
With changing chant, now hoarse,  
now shrill,

Keeps dinning like a mighty  
hive.

A furnace over field and mead,  
The rounding noon hangs hard  
and white;  
Into the gathering heats recede  
The hollows of the Chelsea  
height;  
But under all to one quiet tune,  
A spirit in cool depths  
withdrawn,  
With logs, and dust, and wrack  
bestrewn,  
The stately river journeys on.

I watch the swinging currents go  
Far down to where, enclosed and  
piled,  
The logs crowd, and the Gatineau  
Comes rushing from the  
northern wild.  
I see the long low point, where close  
The shore-lines, and the waters  
end,  
I watch the barges pass in rows  
That vanish at the tapering bend.

I see as at the noon's pale core—  
A shadow that lifts clear and  
floats—  
The cabin'd village round the shore,  
The landing and the fringe of  
boats;  
Faint films of smoke that curl and  
wreathe,  
And upward with the like desire

The vast gray church that seems to  
    breathe  
    In heaven with its dreaming  
    spire.

And there the last blue boundaries  
    rise,  
    That guard within their compass  
    furled  
This plot of earth: beyond them lies  
    The mystery of the echoing  
    world;  
And still my thought goes on, and  
    yields  
    New vision and new joy to me,  
Far peopled hills, and ancient fields,  
    And cities by the crested sea.

I see no more the barges pass,  
    Nor mark the ripple round the  
    pier,  
And all the uproar, mass on mass,  
    Falls dead upon a vacant ear.  
Beyond the tumult of the mills,  
    And all the city's sound and  
    strife,  
Beyond the waste, beyond the hills,  
    I look far out and dream of life.

---

## SEPTEMBER

Now hath the summer reached her  
    golden close,  
And, lost amid her corn-fields,  
    bright of soul,  
Scarcely perceives from her divine  
    repose  
How near, how swift, the  
    inevitable goal:  
Still, still, she smiles, though from  
    her careless feet  
The bounty and the fruitful  
    strength are gone,  
And through the soft long  
    wondering days goes on  
The silent sere decadence sad and  
    sweet.

The kingbird and the pensive thrush  
    are fled,  
Children of light, too fearful of  
    the gloom;  
The sun falls low, the secret word is  
    said,  
The mouldering woods grow  
    silent as the tomb;  
Even the fields have lost their  
    sovereign grace,  
The cone-flower and the  
    marguerite; and no more,  
Across the river's shadow-  
    haunted floor,

The paths of skimming swallows  
interlace.

Already in the outland wilderness  
The forests echo with unwonted  
dins;  
In clamorous gangs the gathering  
woodmen press  
Northward, and the stern  
winter's toil begins.  
Around the long low shanties, whose  
rough lines  
Break the sealed dreams of  
many an unnamed lake,  
Already in the frost-clear morns  
awake  
The crash and thunder of the falling  
pines.

Where the tilled earth, with all its  
fields set free,  
Naked and yellow from the  
harvest lies,  
By many a loft and busy granary,  
The hum and tumult of the  
thrashers rise;  
There the tanned farmers labor  
without slack,  
Till twilight deepens round the  
spouting mill,  
Feeding the loosened sheaves, or  
with fierce will,  
Pitching waist-deep upon the dusty  
stack.

Still a brief while, ere the old year  
quite pass,

Our wandering steps and wistful  
    eyes shall greet  
The leaf, the water, the beloved grass;  
    Still from these haunts and this  
        accustomed seat  
I see the wood-wrapt city, swept with  
    light,  
    The blue long-shadowed  
        distance, and, between,  
    The dotted farm-lands with their  
        parcelled green,  
The dark pine forest and the watchful  
    height.

I see the broad rough meadow  
    stretched away  
    Into the crystal sunshine, wastes  
        of sod,  
Acres of withered vervain, purple-  
    gray,  
    Branches of aster, groves of  
        goldenrod;  
And yonder, toward the sunlit  
    summit, strewn  
    With shadowy boulders,  
        crowned and swathed  
        with weed,  
    Stand ranks of silken thistles,  
        blown to seed,  
Long silver fleeces shining like the  
    noon.

In far-off russet corn-fields, where the  
    dry  
    Gray shocks stand peaked and  
        withering, half concealed

In the rough earth, the orange  
pumpkins lie,  
Full-ribbed; and in the windless  
pasture-field  
The sleek red horses o'er the sun-  
warmed ground  
Stand pensively about in  
companies,  
While all around them from the  
motionless trees  
The long clean shadows sleep without  
a sound.

Under cool elm-trees floats the  
distant stream,  
Moveless as air; and o'er the vast  
warm earth  
The fathomless daylight seems to  
stand and dream,  
A liquid cool elixir—all its girth  
Bound with faint haze, a frail  
transparency,  
Whose lucid purple barely veils  
and fills  
The utmost valleys and the thin  
last hills,  
Nor mars one whit their perfect  
clarity.

Thus without grief the golden days go  
by,  
So soft we scarcely notice how  
they wend,  
And like a smile half happy, or a sigh,  
The summer passes to her quiet  
end;

And soon, too soon, around the  
    cumbered eaves  
Sly frosts shall take the creepers  
    by surprise,  
And through the wind-touched  
    reddening woods shall  
    rise  
October with the rain of ruined  
    leaves.

---

## A RE-ASSURANCE

With what doubting eyes, oh sparrow,  
    Thou regardest me,  
Underneath yon spray of yarrow,  
    Dipping cautiously.

Fear me not, oh little sparrow,  
    Bathe and never fear,  
For to me both pool and yarrow  
    And thyself are dear.

---

## THE POET'S POSSESSION

Think not, oh master of the well-tilled  
field,  
This earth is only thine; for after thee,  
When all is sown and gathered and  
put by,  
Comes the grave poet with creative  
eye,  
And from these silent acres and clean  
plots,  
Bids with his wand the fancied after-  
yield,  
A second tilth and second harvest, be,  
The crop of images and curious  
thoughts.

---

## AN AUTUMN LANDSCAPE

No wind there is that either pipes or  
moans;  
The fields are cold and still; the  
sky  
Is covered with a blue-gray  
sheet  
Of motionless cloud; and at  
my feet  
The river, curling softly by,  
Whispers and dimples round its quiet  
gray stones.

Along the chill green slope that dips  
and heaves  
The road runs rough and silent,  
lined  
With plum-trees, misty and  
blue-gray,  
And poplars pallid as the  
day,  
In masses spectral, undefined,  
Pale greenish stems half hid in dry  
gray leaves.

And on beside the river's sober edge  
A long fresh field lies black.  
Beyond,  
Low thickets gray and  
reddish stand,  
Stroked white with birch;  
and near at hand,  
Over a little steel-smooth pond,

Hang multitudes of thin and  
withering sedge.

Across a waste and solitary rise  
A ploughman urges his dull  
team,  
A stooped gray figure with  
prone brow  
That plunges bending to the  
plough  
With strong, uneven steps. The  
stream  
Rings and re-echoes with his furious  
cries.

Sometimes the lowing of a cow, long-  
drawn,  
Comes from far off; and crows  
in strings  
Pass on the upper silences.  
A flock of small gray  
goldfinches,  
Flown down with silvery  
twitterings,  
Rustle among the birch-cones and are  
gone.

This day the season seems like one  
that heeds,  
With fixèd ear and lifted hand,  
All moods that yet are  
known on earth,  
All motions that have  
faintest birth,  
If haply she may understand  
The utmost inward sense of all her  
deeds.



## IN NOVEMBER

With loitering step and quiet eye,  
Beneath the low November sky,  
I wandered in the woods, and found  
A clearing, where the broken ground  
Was scattered with black stumps and  
                  briers,

And the old wreck of forest fires.  
It was a bleak and sandy spot,  
And, all about, the vacant plot  
Was peopled and inhabited  
By scores of mulleins long since  
                  dead.

A silent and forsaken brood  
In that mute opening of the wood,  
So shrivelled and so thin they were,  
So gray, so haggard, and austere,  
Not plants at all they seemed to me,  
But rather some spare company  
Of hermit folk, who long ago,  
Wandering in bodies to and fro,  
Had chanced upon this lonely way,  
And rested thus, till death one day  
Surprised them at their compline  
                  prayer,  
And left them standing lifeless there.

There was no sound about the wood  
Save the wind's secret stir. I stood  
Among the mullein-stalks as still  
As if myself had grown to be  
One of their sombre company,  
A body without wish or will.

And as I stood, quite suddenly,  
Down from a furrow in the sky  
The sun shone out a little space  
Across that silent sober place,  
Over the sand heaps and brown sod,  
The mulleins and dead goldenrod,  
And passed beyond the thickets gray,  
And lit the fallen leaves that lay,  
Level and deep within the wood,  
A rustling yellow multitude.

And all around me the thin light,  
So sere, so melancholy bright,  
Fell like the half-reflected gleam  
Or shadow of some former dream;  
A moment's golden revery  
Poured out on every plant and tree  
A semblance of weird joy, or less,  
A sort of spectral happiness;  
And I, too, standing idly there,  
With muffled hands in the chill air,  
Felt the warm glow about my feet,  
And shuddering betwixt cold and  
    heat,  
Drew my thoughts closer, like a  
    cloak,  
While something in my blood awoke,  
A nameless and unnatural cheer,  
A pleasure secret and austere.

---

## BY AN AUTUMN STREAM

Now overhead,  
Where the rivulet loiters and stops,  
The bittersweet hangs from the tops  
Of the alders and cherries  
Its bunches of beautiful berries,  
Orange and red.

And the snowbirds flee,  
Tossing up on the far brown field,  
Now flashing and now concealed,  
Like fringes of spray  
That vanish and gleam on the gray  
Field of the sea.

Flickering light,  
Come the last of the leaves down  
    borne,  
And patches of pale white corn  
In the wind complain,  
Like the slow rustle of rain  
Noticed by night.

Withered and thinned,  
The sentinel mullein looms,  
With the pale gray shadowy plumes  
Of the goldenrod;  
And the milkweed opens its pod,  
Tempting the wind.

Aloft on the hill,  
A cloudrift opens and shines  
Through a break in its gorget of  
    pines,

And it dreams at my feet  
In a sad, silvery sheet,  
Utterly still.

All things that be  
Seem plunged into silence,  
    distraught,  
By some stern, some necessitous  
    thought:  
It wraps and enthralls  
Marsh, meadow, and forest; and falls  
Also on me.

---

## SNOWBIRDS

Along the narrow sandy height  
I watch them swiftly come and  
go,  
Or round the leafless wood,  
Like flurries of wind-driven  
snow,  
Revolving in perpetual flight,  
A changing multitude.

Nearer and nearer still they sway,  
And, scattering in a circled  
sweep,  
Rush down without a  
sound;  
And now I see them peer and  
peep,  
Across yon level bleak and gray,  
Searching the frozen  
ground,—

Until a little wind upheaves,  
And makes a sudden rustling  
there,  
And then they drop their  
play,  
Flash up into the sunless air,  
And like a flight of silver leaves  
Swirl round and sweep  
away.

---

## SNOW

White are the far-off plains, and white  
    The fading forests grow;  
The wind dies out along the height,  
    And denser still the snow,  
A gathering weight on roof and tree,  
    Falls down scarce audibly.

The road before me smooths and fills  
    Apace, and all about  
The fences dwindle, and the hills  
    Are blotted slowly out;  
The naked trees loom spectrally  
    Into the dim white sky.

The meadows and far-sheeted streams  
    Lie still without a sound;  
Like some soft minister of dreams  
    The snow-fall hoods me  
        round;  
In wood and water, earth and air,  
    A silence everywhere.

Save when at lonely intervals  
    Some farmer's sleigh, urged  
        on,  
With rustling runners and sharp bells,  
    Swings by me and is gone;  
Or from the empty waste I hear  
    A sound remote and clear;

The barking of a dog, or call  
    To cattle, sharply pealed,

Borne echoing from some wayside  
stall

Or barnyard far a-field;  
Then all is silent, and the snow  
Falls, settling soft and slow.

The evening deepens, and the gray  
Folds closer earth and sky;  
The world seems shrouded far away;  
Its noises sleep, and I,  
As secret as yon buried stream,  
Plod dumbly on, and  
dream.

---

## SUNSET

From this windy bridge at rest,  
In some former curious hour,  
We have watched the city's hue,  
All along the orange west,  
Cupola and pointed tower,  
Darken into solid blue.

Tho' the biting north wind breaks  
Full across this drifted hold,  
Let us stand with icèd cheeks  
Watching westward as of old;

Past the violet mountain-head  
To the farthest fringe of pine,  
Where far off the purple-red  
Narrows to a dusky line,  
And the last pale splendors die  
Slowly from the olive sky;

Till the thin clouds wear away  
Into threads of purple-gray,  
And the sudden stars between  
Brighten in the pallid green;

Till above the spacious east,  
Slow returnèd one by one,  
Like pale prisoners released  
From the dungeons of the sun,  
Capella and her train appear  
In the glittering Charioteer;

Till the rounded moon shall grow  
Great above the eastern snow,

Shining into burnished gold;  
And the silver earth outrolled,  
In the misty yellow light,  
Shall take on the width of night.

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## WINTER-STORE

Subtly conscious, all awake,  
Let us clear our eyes, and break  
Through the cloudy chrysalis,  
See the wonder as it is.  
Down a narrow alley, blind,  
Touch and vision, heart and mind;  
Turned sharply inward, still we plod,  
Till the calmly smiling god  
Leaves us, and our spirits grow  
More thin, more acrid, as we go.  
Creeping by the sullen wall,  
We forego the power to see,  
The threads that bind us to the All,  
God or the Immensity;  
Whereof on the eternal road  
Man is but a passing mode.

Too blind we are, too little see  
Of the magic pageantry,  
Every minute, every hour,  
From the cloudflake to the flower,  
Forever old, forever strange,  
Issuing in perpetual change  
From the rainbow gates of Time.

But he who through this common air  
Surely knows the great and fair,  
What is lovely, what sublime,  
Becomes in an increasing span,  
One with earth and one with man,  
One, despite these mortal scars,  
With the planets and the stars;  
And Nature from her holy place,

Bending with unveiled face,  
Fills him in her divine employ  
With her own majestic joy.

Up the fielded slopes at morn,  
Where light wefts of shadow pass,  
Films upon the bending corn,  
I shall sweep the purple grass.  
Sun-crowned heights and mossy  
    woods,  
And the outer solitudes,  
Mountain-valleys, dim with pine,  
Shall be home and haunt of mine.  
I shall search in crannied hollows,  
Where the sunlight scarcely follows,  
And the secret forest brook  
Murmurs, and from nook to nook  
Forever downward curls and cools,  
Frothing in the bouldered pools.

Many a noon shall find me laid  
In the pungent balsam shade,  
Where sharp breezes spring and  
    shiver  
On some deep rough-coasted river,  
And the plangent waters come,  
Amber-hued and streaked with foam;  
Where beneath the sunburnt hills  
All day long the crowded mills  
With remorseless champ and scream  
Overlord the sluicing stream,  
And the rapids' iron roar  
Hammers at the forest's core;  
Where corded rafts creep slowly on,  
Glittering in the noonday sun,  
And the tawny river-dogs,  
Shepherding the branded logs,

Bind and heave with cadenced cry;  
Where the blackened tugs go by,  
Panting hard and straining slow,  
Laboring at the weighty tow,  
Flat-nosed barges all in trim,  
Creeping in long cumbrous line,  
Loaded to the water's brim  
With the clean, cool-scented pine.

Perhaps in some low meadow-land,  
Stretching wide on either hand,  
I shall see the belted bees  
Rocking with the tricky breeze  
In the spirèd meadow-sweet,  
Or with eager trampling feet  
Burrowing in the boneset blooms,  
Treading out the dry perfumes.  
Where sun-hot hay-fields newly  
    mown  
Climb the hillside ruddy brown,  
I shall see the haymakers,  
While the noonday scarcely stirs,  
Brown of neck and booted gray,  
Tossing up the rustling hay,  
While the hay-racks bend and rock,  
As they take each scented cock,  
Jolting over dip and rise;  
And the wavering butterflies  
O'er the spaces brown and bare  
Light and wander here and there.

I shall stray by many a stream,  
Where the half-shut lilies gleam.  
Napping out the sultry days  
In the quiet secluded bays;  
Where the tasseled rushes tower,  
O'er the purple pickerel-flower.

And the floating dragon-fly—  
Azure glint and crystal gleam—  
Watches o'er the burnished stream  
With his eye of ebony;  
Where the bull-frog lolls at rest  
On his float of lily-leaves,  
That the swaying water weaves,  
And distends his yellow breast,  
Lowing out from shore to shore  
With a hollow vibrant roar;  
Where the softest wind that blows  
As it lightly comes and goes,  
O'er the jungled river meads,  
Stirs a whisper in the reeds,  
And wakes the crowded bull-rushes  
From their stately reveries,  
Flashing through their long-leaved  
          hordes  
Like a brandishing of swords;  
There, too, the frost-like arrow-  
          flowers  
Tremble to the golden core,  
Children of enchanted hours,  
Whom the rustling river bore  
In the night's bewildered noon,  
Woven of water and the moon.

I shall hear the grasshoppers  
From the parched grass rehearse,  
And with drowsy note prolong  
Evermore the same thin song.  
I shall hear the crickets tell  
Stories by the humming well,  
And mark the locust, with quaint  
          eyes,  
Caper in his cloak of gray  
Like a jester in disguise

Rattling by the dusty way.

I shall dream by upland fences,  
Where the season's wealth condenses  
Over many a weedy wreck,  
Wild, uncared-for, desert places,  
That sovereign Beauty loves to deck  
With her softest, dearest graces.  
There the long year dreams in quiet,  
And the summer's strength runs riot.  
Shall I not remember these,  
Deep in winter reveries?  
Berried brier and thistle-bloom,  
And milkweed with its dense  
    perfume;  
Slender vervain towering up  
In a many-branchèd cup,  
Like a candlestick, each spire  
Kindled with a violet fire;  
Matted creepers and wild cherries,  
Purple-bunchèd elderberries,  
And on scanty plots of sod  
Groves of branchy goldenrod.

What though autumn mornings now,  
Winterward with glittering brow,  
Stiffen in the silver grass;  
And what though robins flock and  
    pass,  
With subdued and sober call,  
To the old year's funeral;  
Though October's crimson leaves  
Rustle at the gusty door,  
And the tempest round the eaves  
Alternate with pipe and roar;  
I sit, as erst, unharmed, secure,  
Conscious that my store is sure,

Whatsoever the fenced fields,  
Or the untilled forest yields  
Of unhurt remembrances,  
Or thoughts, far-glimpsed, half-  
followed, these  
I have reaped and laid away,  
A treasure of unwinnowed grain,  
To the garner packed and gray  
Gathered without toil or strain.

And when the darker days shall  
come,  
And the fields are white and dumb;  
When our fires are half in vain,  
And the crystal starlight weaves  
Mockeries of summer leaves,  
Pictured on the icy pane;  
When the high aurora gleams  
Far above the Arctic streams  
Like a line of shifting spears,  
And the broad pine-circled meres,  
Glimmering in that spectral light,  
Thunder through the northern night;  
Then within the bolted door  
I shall con my summer store;  
Though the fences scarcely show  
Black above the drifted snow,  
Though the icy sweeping wind  
Whistle in the empty tree,  
Safe within the sheltered mind,  
I shall feed on memory.

Yet across the windy night  
Comes upon its wings a cry;  
Fashioned forms and modes take  
flight,  
And a vision sad and high

Of the laboring world down there,  
Where the lights burn red and warm,  
Pricks my soul with sudden stare,  
Glowing through the veils of storm.  
In the city yonder sleep  
Those who smile and those who  
    weep,  
Those whose lips are set with care,  
Those whose brows are smooth and  
    fair;  
Mourners whom the dawning light  
Shall grapple with an old distress;  
Lovers folded at midnight  
In their bridal happiness;  
Pale watchers by belovèd beds,  
Fallen a-drowse with nodding heads,  
Whom sleep captured by surprise,  
With the circles round their eyes;  
Maidens with quiet-taken breath,  
Dreaming of enchanted bowers;  
Old men with the mask of death;  
Little children soft as flowers;  
Those who wake wild-eyed and start  
In some madness of the heart;  
Those whose lips and brows of stone  
Evil thoughts have graven upon,  
Shade by shade and line by line,  
Refashioning what was once divine.

All these sleep, and through the night,  
Comes a passion and a cry,  
With a blind sorrow and a might,  
I know not whence, I know not why,  
A something I cannot control,  
A nameless hunger of the soul.  
It holds me fast. In vain, in vain,  
I remember how of old

I saw the ruddy race of men,  
Through the glittering world  
    outrolled,  
A gay-smiling multitude,  
All immortal, all divine,  
Treading in a wreathèd line  
By a pathway through a wood.

---

## THE SUN CUP

The earth is the cup of the sun,  
That he filleth at morning with wine,  
With the warm, strong wine of his  
    might  
From the vintage of gold and of light,  
Fills it, and makes it divine.

And at night when his journey is  
    done,  
At the gate of his radiant hall,  
He setteth his lips to the brim,  
With a long last look of his eye,  
And lifts it and draineth it dry,  
Drains till he leaveth it all  
Empty and hollow and dim.

And then, as he passes to sleep,  
Still full of the feats that he did,  
Long ago in Olympian wars,  
He closes it down with the sweep  
Of its slow-turning luminous lid,  
Its cover of darkness and stars,  
Wrought once by Hephæstus of old  
With violet and vastness and gold.

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